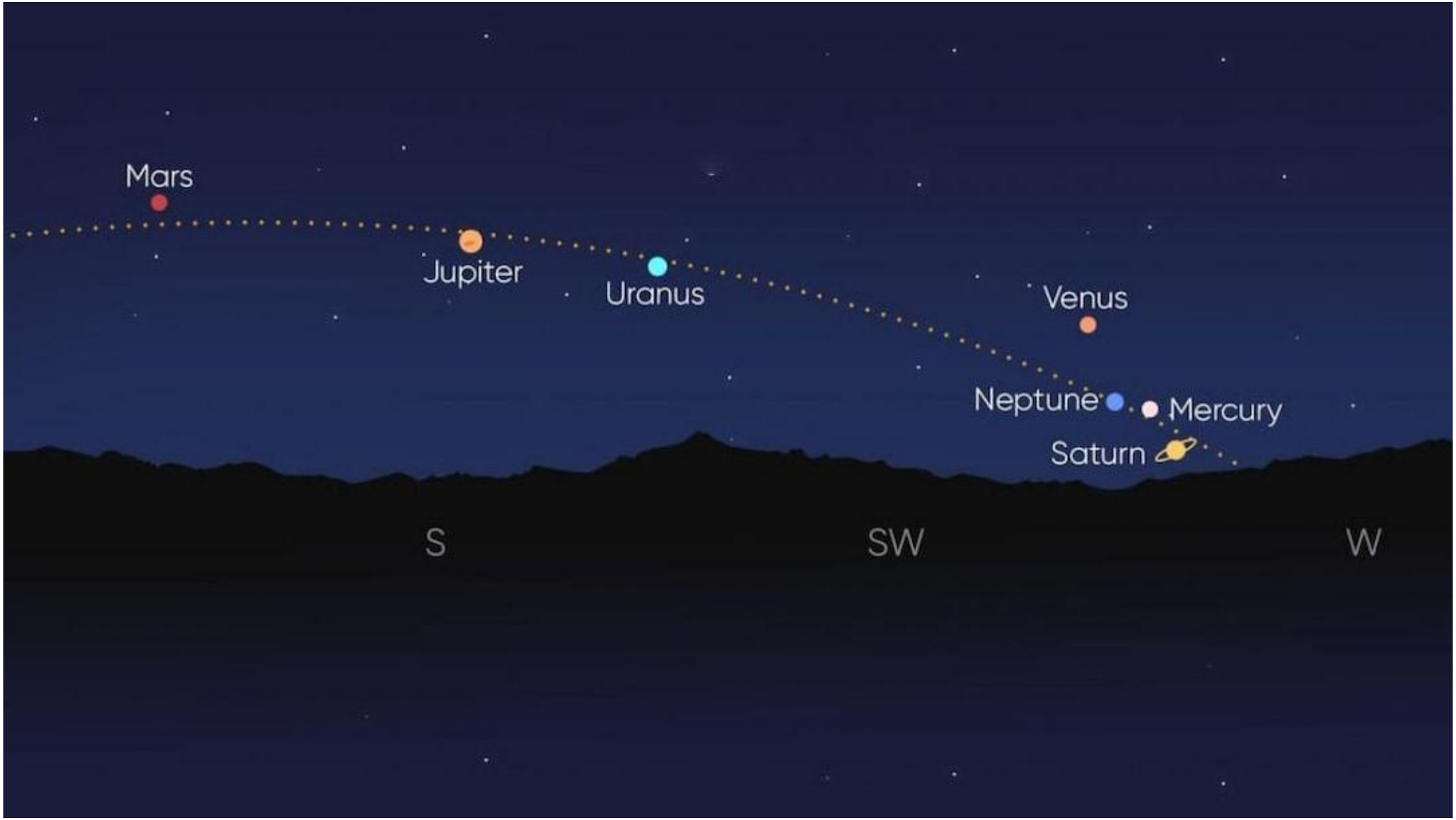
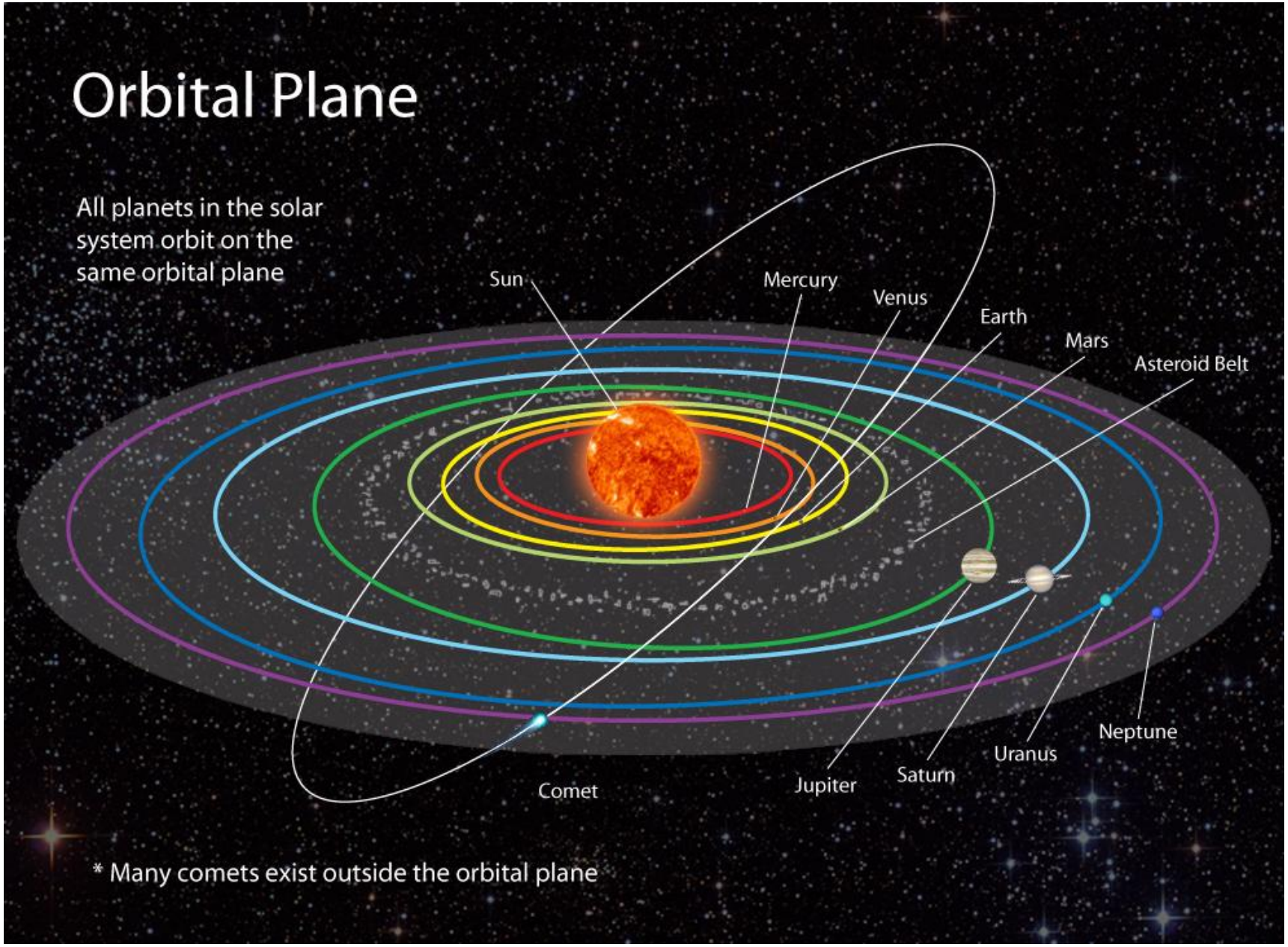
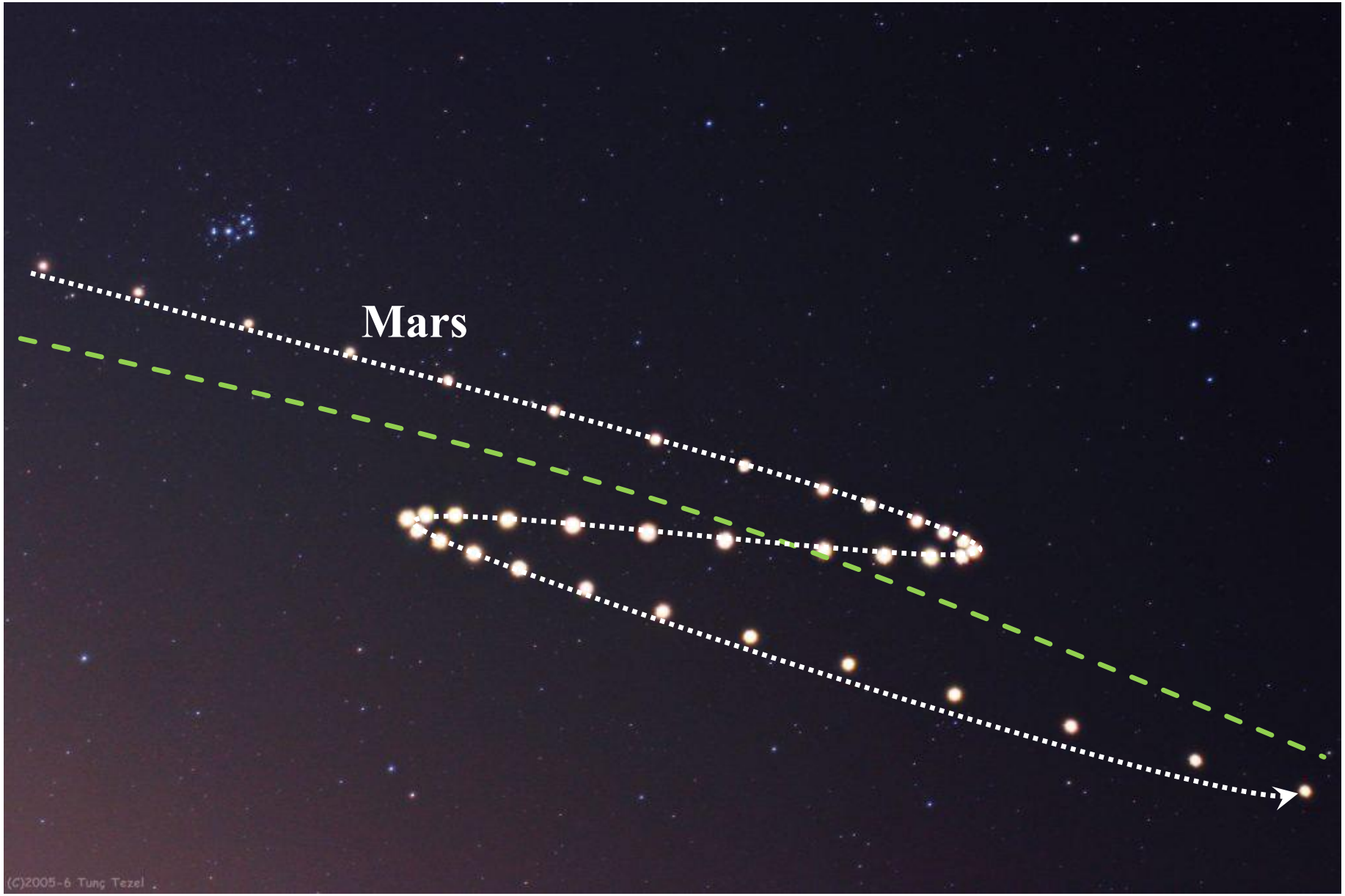
UNDER A SEA
OF STARS



https://www.terramiagiornale.it/rarissimo-allineamento-planetario-il-28-febbraio-2025-visibile-anche-al-sud-italia/

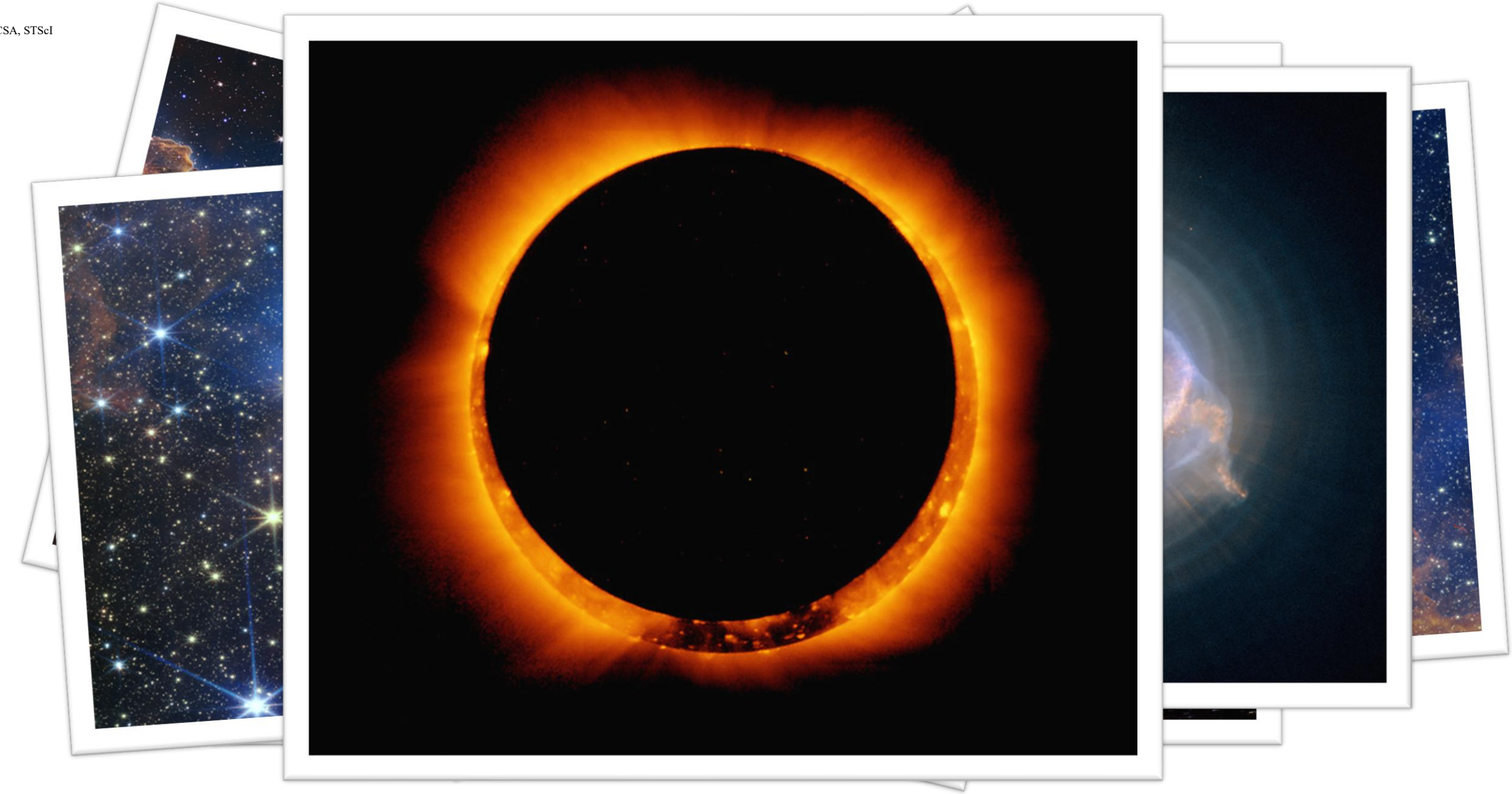


Tim Gunther, Illustrator



Tunk Tezel, 2005-6

NASA, ESA, CSA, STScI



ANCIENT CULTURES

CHINA: THE SUN-EATER DRAGON

https://studycli.org/chinese-culture/chinese-dragons/

GREECE and ROME: ASTRONOMY and RELIGION

https://catalogo.beniculturali.it/

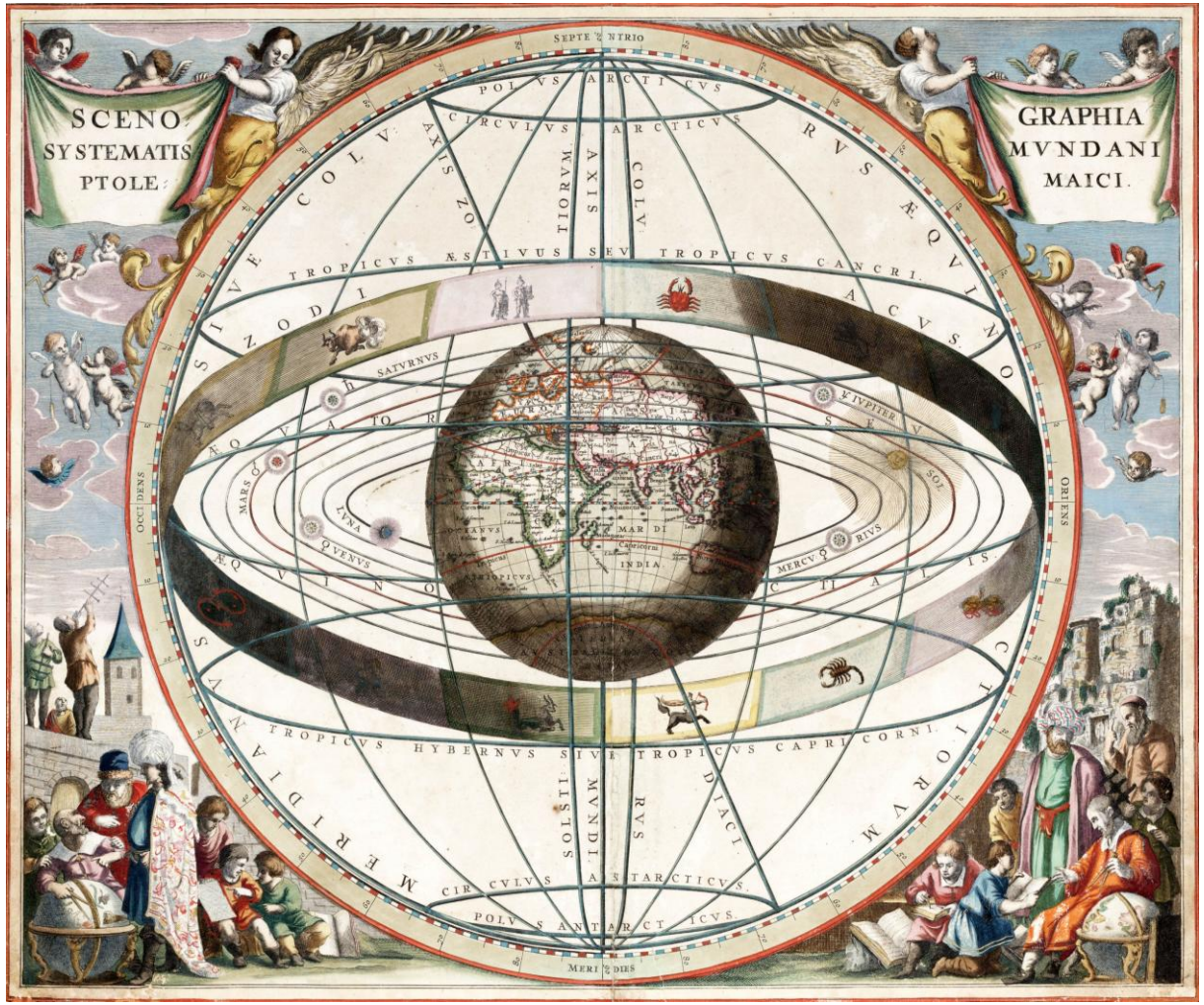
EGYPT: THE STARS, A PATH TO THE AFTERLIFE

ESO/P.Horalek

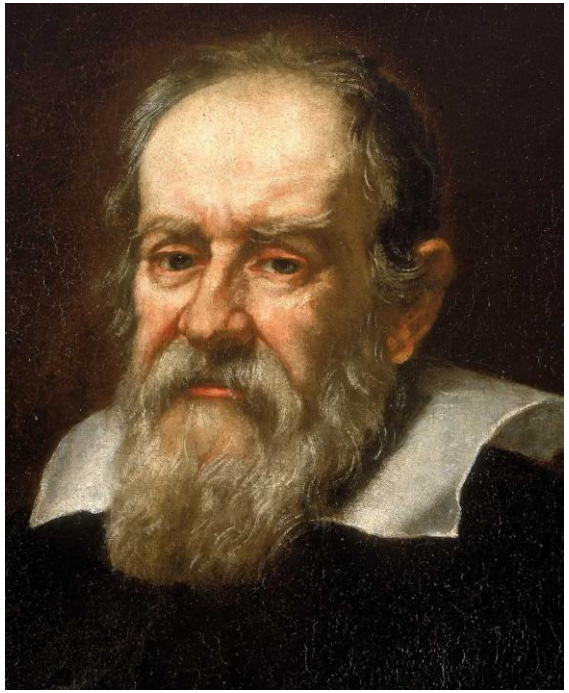
VIKINGS: COSMIC WOLVES

https://www.pinterest.com/ehall2812/hati-skoll-and-fenrir/

THE CHURCH: THE HUMAN-CENTERED UNIVERSE



Loon, J. van (Johannes)



Justus Sustermans

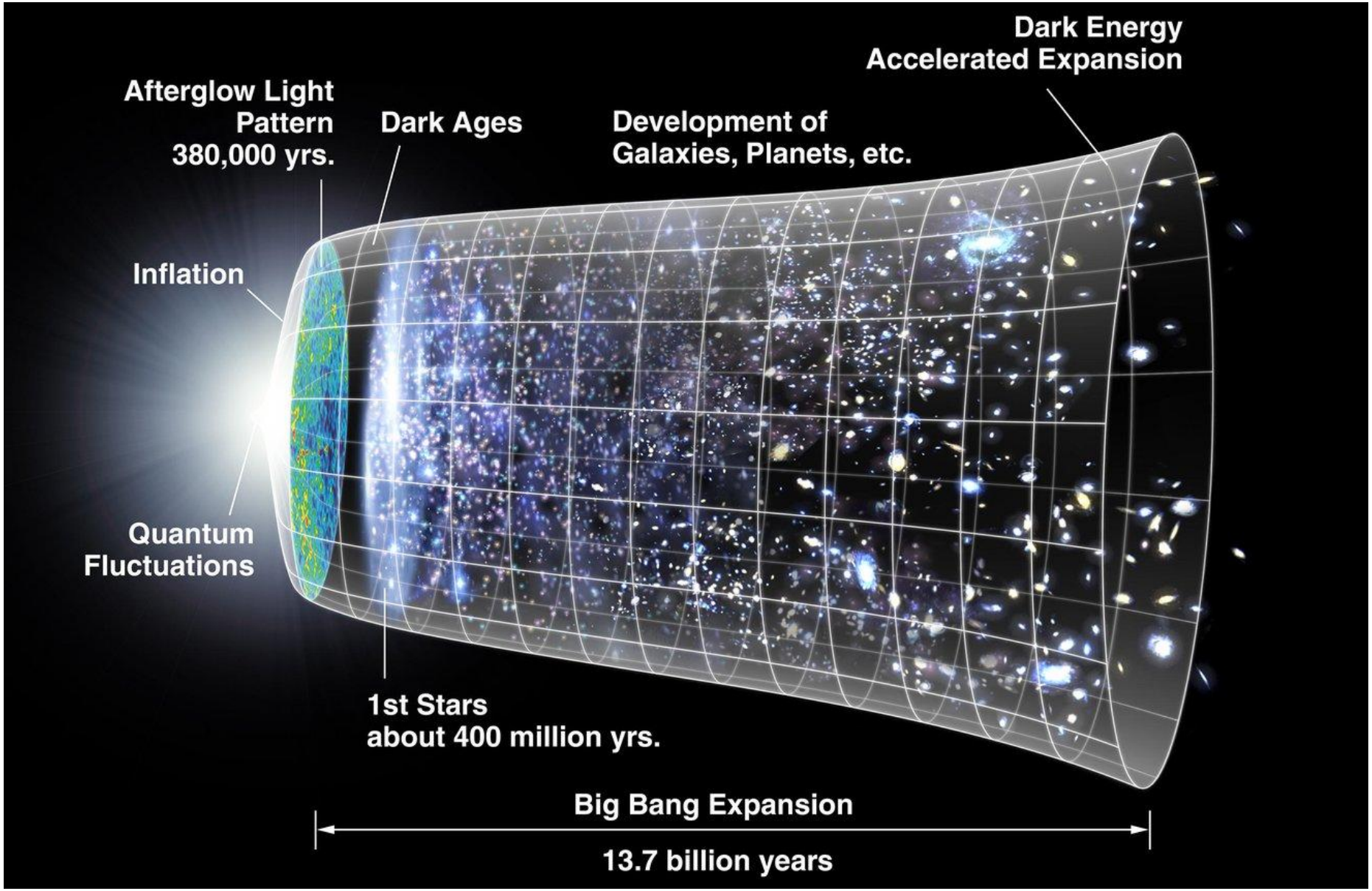
...but...

what about science?

MODERN COSMOLOGY

NASA's Goddard Space Flight Center/CI Lab

The History of the Universe

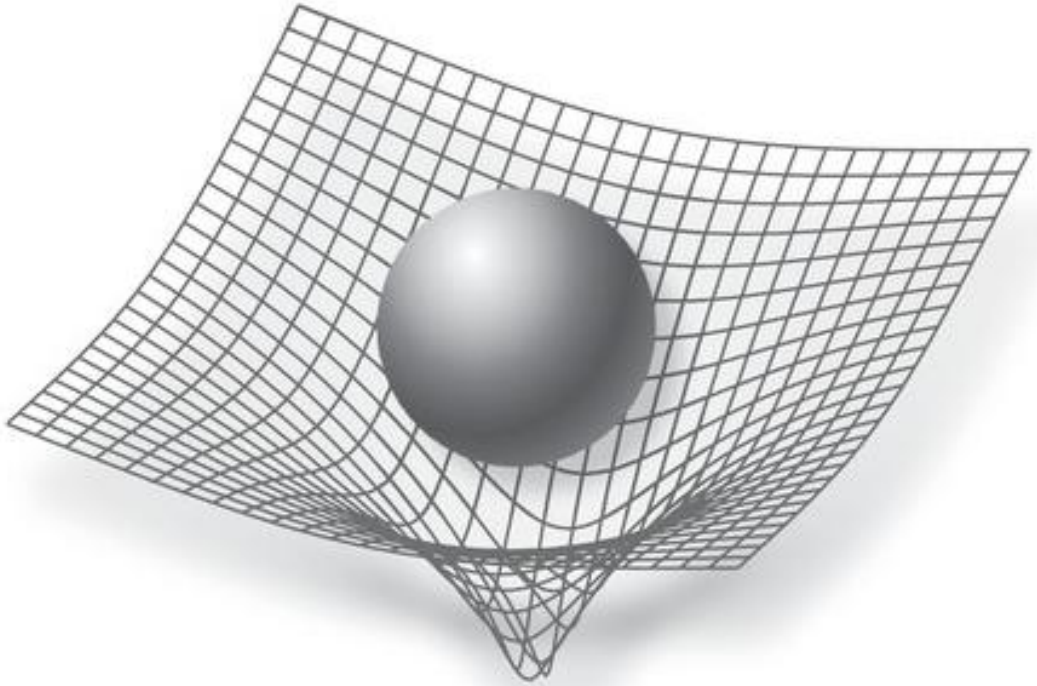


NASA/WMAP Science Team - Original version: NASA; modified by Cherkash

WE HAVE ACCOMPLISHED A COUPLE OF THINGS LATELY

1905 and 1916

Einstein published his two relativity theories: Special Relativity and General Relativity. Its fundamental equations allowed astrophysicists and cosmologists to link gravity and the curvature of the space-time



Rezzolla, L. (2023) 'Spacetime, Curvature and Gravity', in *The Irresistible Attraction of Gravity: A Journey to Discover Black Holes*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, pp. 25–48.

WE HAVE ACCOMPLISHED A COUPLE OF THINGS LATELY

1923

Edwin Hubble proved the existence of other galaxies besides ours

Oh…and yeah, he also confirmed the hypothesis of Big Bang some years later…

NASA; ESA

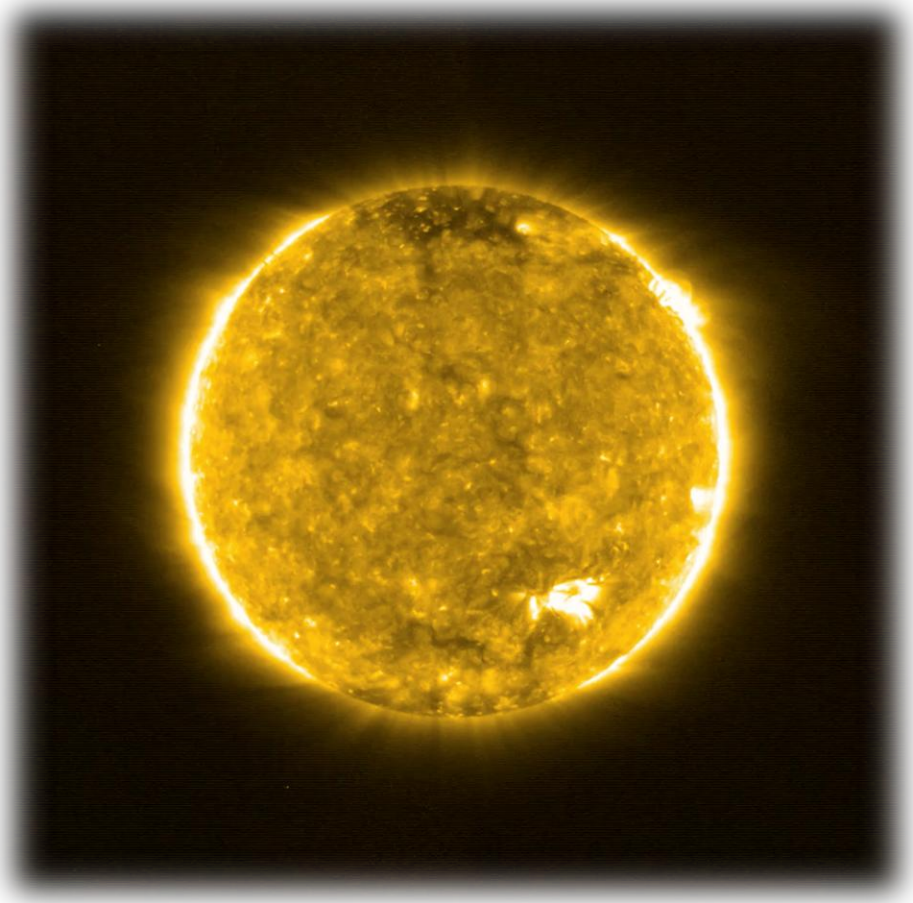
ESA, Tony and Daphne Hallas

WE HAVE ACCOMPLISHED A COUPLE OF THINGS LATELY

1925 and 1938

Thanks to the efforts of so many scientists, we now know what is hidden inside stars and how they work.

We understood the nuclear reactions in an extreme environment such as the star's core



Solar Orbiter/EUI Team; PHI Team; Metis Team; SoloHI Team /ESA & NASA

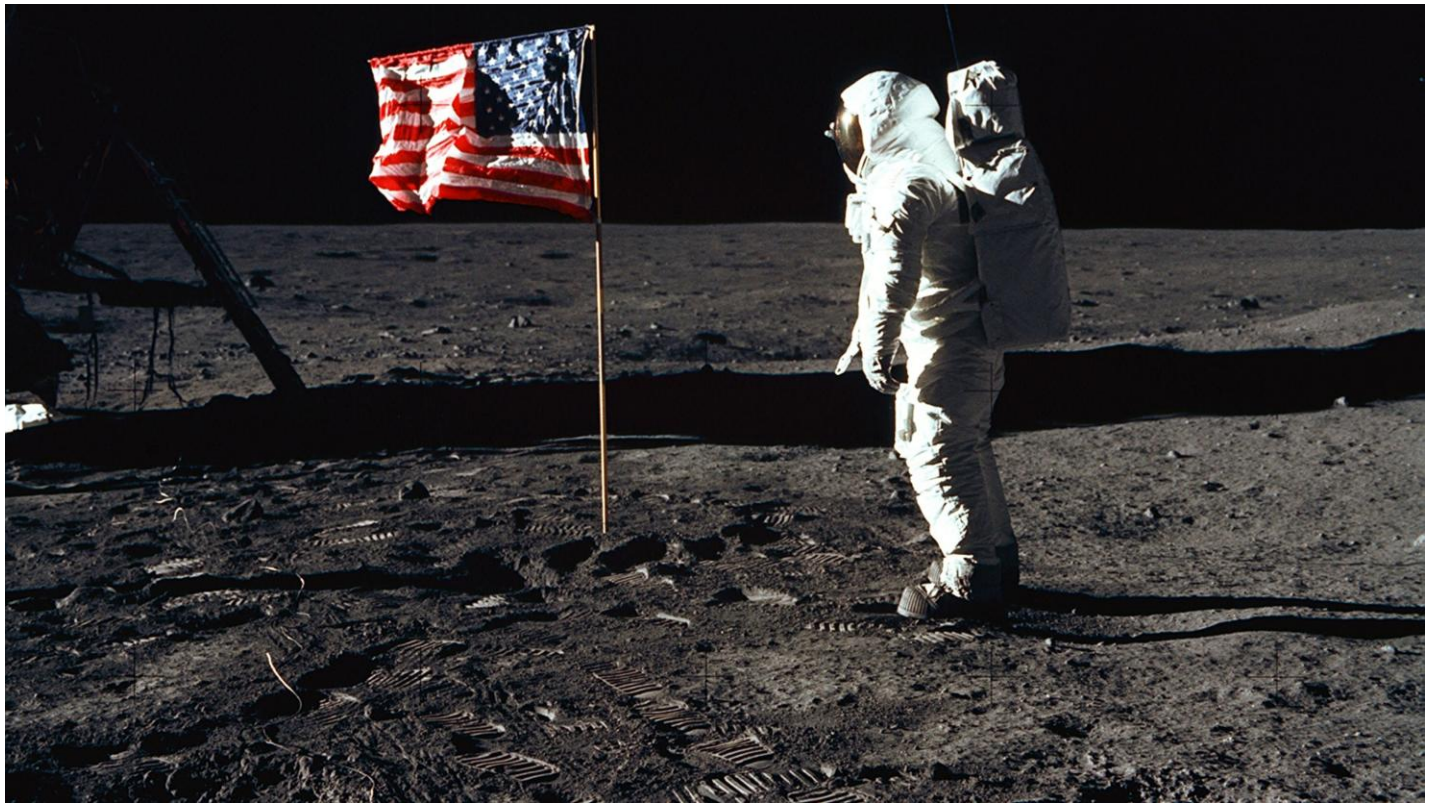
WE HAVE ACCOMPLISHED A COUPLE OF THINGS LATELY

1969

Apollo 11 mission, we landed on the Moon.

"Here men from the Planet Earth first set foot upon the moon, July 1969, A.D. We came in peace for all mankind."

- Neil Armstrong

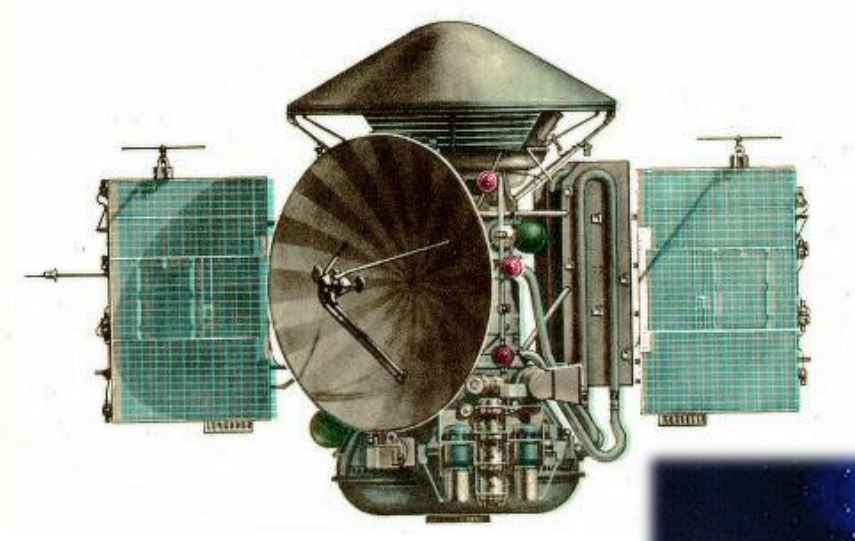


NASA/Hulton Archive/Getty Images

WE HAVE ACCOMPLISHED A COUPLE OF THINGS LATELY

1971 and 2012

For the first time, a mission landed on another planet, Mars, and a probe entered the interstellar space



NASA, Soviet Mars 3

NASA, Voyager 1

WE HAVE ACCOMPLISHED A COUPLE OF THINGS LATELY

1972 and 2019

Charles Thomas Bolton confirmed the existence of a Black Hole and we now have an image

Event Horizon Telescope Collaboration

And we have mentioned just a few discoveries!

We are now living in the most exciting moments for the astrophysical and cosmological research and the next years are going to be filled up with missions aimed at expanding our knowledge of the Universe

https://www.media.inaf.it/2013/06/29/ciao-margherita/

"In ancient times, man, deceived by his senses, believed that the Earth was the center of the universe. Then he realized that the Earth and the planets revolved around the Sun, which was at the center of the solar system. Later, he understood that the Sun is a star like billions of others, while the deception of the senses had still led him to believe that the Sun was at the center of the Milky Way, and that this embraced the entire universe. Over time, he discovered that the Sun occupies a peripheral position in the Milky Way, which is just one galaxy among billions of others, and that all of them together make up our universe. And now we ask ourselves: is this really all that exists, or is it just one universe among infinite others?"

Thank You